

NIKITA FOKIN

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Team Lead Data Scientist in e-Grocery/e-Commerce with strong business-sense, product experience, leadership skills, and deep technical expertise. Led a team of up to 4 people: 3 MLEs and 1 MLOps. Gained unique experience in Big Tech, working on a wide range of projects from zero-to-one initiatives to production-ready ML systems. My main focus has been on operational and commercial ML problems, including order and demand forecasting, courier shift planning, dynamic pricing, promo mechanics, and elasticity estimation. In addition to applied business ML, I have a strong research and academic background, including teaching experience in ML, econometrics, and statistics at a leading economics university.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Team Lead ML

ecom.tech / Samokat

Dec 2025 – present

Moscow, Russia

- Worked as part of the product team, building strong relationships with business stakeholders, managing expectations, and translating product needs into ML tasks and deliverables. Established a continuous A/B testing process for ML-driven product changes, which helped validate model impact at scale and significantly increased trust from business stakeholders.
- Led a core operations ML team of up to 4 people, including 3 ML Engineers and 1 MLOps/Backend Engineer; mentored an intern and helped grow him to a junior specialist level.
- Owned ML solutions for large-scale operational forecasting across 2,400+ Samokat dark stores, including order and demand forecasting, workforce shift planning for couriers and pickers, and minimum order amount optimization as a key demand management lever.
- Planned and prioritized the ML backlog, aligned technical initiatives with business impact, and coordinated delivery across research, engineering, and productionization stages.

Senior ML Engineer

ecom.tech / Samokat

Mar 2025 – Dec 2025

Moscow, Russia

- Developed a model for managing courier workload. The model helps the service save almost 5% of courier payroll costs by increasing courier utilization and efficiently allocating courier hours across fulfillment centers and time slots, while preserving service quality and not increasing delivery delays.

Contributed to the development of a dynamic pricing model for managing discounts and promotional mechanics on Samokat's product storefront, including user segmentation.

Middle+ ML Engineer

ecom.tech / Megamarket

Jan 2024 – Mar 2025

Moscow, Russia

Developed a dynamic pricing model that recommends optimal prices to merchants and manages discounts for Megamarket's 1P products. The project also included Causal Inference models for estimating the impact of different discount types on sales across product categories.

Senior Researcher

Gaidar Institute for Economic Policy

Oct 2017 – present

Moscow, Russia

- Top 100 Russian Economists according to REPEC Rankings [link](#).
- Published more than 20 articles in top Russian and international journals, with 14 of them listed in Scopus or Web of Science (most in Q1 and Q2 journals). Almost full list available at the [link](#).
- Launched and supported several forecasting models for key Russian macroeconomic variables, which serve as the basis for producing analytical notes for the Government of the Russian Federation.

- Launching models for building price indices and analyzing dynamic pricing processes in the short-term housing rental market (In progress).
- Successfully completed a consulting project on building time series forecasting models for a major government institution.
- Hired and led a team of several research interns who were promoted to junior positions and co-authored published few articles in leading Russian journals.

Lecturer at Russian Presidential Academy of National Economy and Public Administration (Faculty of Economics)

09.2018 – 12.2022

Moscow, Russia

- Developed and conducted seminars and homeworks for students: Econometrics, Mathematical Statistics, R
- Coached winners and finalists of the International Econometrics Universiade organized by Lomonosov Moscow State University [link](#).

KEY PUBLICATIONS

Fokin N. (2023). Nowcasting and Forecasting Key Russian Macroeconomic Variables with the MFBVAR Model. *Economic Policy*, 18(3), 110-135. [Link](#) In Russian.

Fokin N. (2021). The Importance of Modeling Structural Breaks in Forecasting Russian GDP. *Applied Econometrics*, 63, 5–29. [Link](#) In Russian.

Mayorova K., Fokin N. (2021). Nowcasting Growth Rates of Russia's Export and Import by Commodity Group. *Russian Journal of Money and Finance*, 80(3), 34-48. [Link](#)

Tretyakov D., Fokin N. (2021). Does The High-frequency Data is Helpful for Forecasting Russian Inflation?. *St Petersburg University Journal of Economic Studies*, 37(2), 318-343. [Link](#) In Russian.

Polbin A., Fokin N. (2020). Modeling the Dynamics of Import in the Russian Federation Using the Error Correction Model. *Applied Econometrics*, 59, 88–112. [Link](#) In Russian.

STACK

IT	Python (ML + DL, PySpark, Polars); SQL; R; Matlab
Expertise	Machine Learning; Econometrics; Time Series Modeling and Forecasting; Statistics
Languages	Russian (native); English (upper-intermediate)

EDUCATION

Russian Presidential Academy of National Economy and Public Administration (RANEPA)	2018 – 2021
<i>PhD in Economics (Thesis Defence In Progress), Major in Economics Theory</i>	Moscow, Russia
Russian Presidential Academy of National Economy and Public Administration (RANEPA)	2016 – 2018
<i>MSc in Economics, Major in Economics and Finance</i>	Moscow, Russia
Russian Presidential Academy of National Economy and Public Administration (RANEPA)	2012 – 2016
<i>BSc in Economics, Major in Economics and Applied Mathematics</i>	Moscow, Russia